

CHETAN BONDE

Procurement Category Specialist — Global IT & Telecom | Software · SaaS · Cloud · Hardware · Managed Services

EUR 62M Spend Under Management | 62 Plants | 130+ Countries | Early AI & MS 365 Copilot Adopter

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Procurement Category Specialist with 5+ years of global IT & Telecom sourcing experience, currently operating at category manager level — owning EUR 62M in Global IT, Telecom & Corporate Services spend at NV Bekaert SA (EUR 3.96B, 62 plants, 130+ countries). Full ownership across Software & SaaS licensing, Hardware & end-user devices, Telecom/Network connectivity, Cloud Services (AWS/Azure/GCP), and IT Managed Services & Outsourcing. Independently reviews redlines and negotiates MSAs, NDAs, and SOWs with Legal in SAP and CLM platforms (GEP). Early adopter of AI and MS 365 Copilot in procurement — Copilot used daily for RFx drafting, contract redline analysis and spend reporting. Built production-grade AI tools (NLP, RPA, RAG for Contract Review) cutting admin workload by 60–70%. Combines a B. Tech in Mechanical Engineering (CGPA 8.85) with a PGDM in Supply Chain Analytics and hands-on proficiency in SAP, GEP Smart, Python, Power BI, and RPA.

KEY ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- EUR 62M Global IT & Telecom spend managed end-to-end — full category ownership across 62 plants, 130+ countries, delivering double-digit recurring savings through SaaS optimization, carrier rationalization, and cloud commercial governance.
- EUR 21M (approx. INR 190 Cr) CAPEX savings — 30% reduction on EUR 70M all-India procurement mandate at JCB Vadodara through competitive tendering, value engineering, and multi-round negotiations.
- 4 live AI procurement tools built and deployed in production at Bekaert: NLP Material De-duplication Engine, RPA + AI end-to-end PO Automation (60–70% admin reduction), and AI Supplier Finder and RAG for contract review
- 400+ supplier contracts governed globally — MSA/NDAs/SOWs independently negotiated, SLA compliance tracked, and CLM renewal metadata maintained across IT, Telecom, and Corporate Services categories.
- 200,000+ SKUs consolidated across 6 countries — volume leverage and category commercial strength delivered across China, India, Slovakia, Belgium, and North America.
- Early AI/Copilot adopter — MS 365 Copilot embedded as standard daily practice in RFx drafting, contract analysis, spend report generation, and CLM metadata enrichment.
- 10-year long-term AMC contracts negotiated at JCB — securing fixed pricing, guaranteed SLAs, and favourable escalation clauses for forklift fleet and logistics categories.

CORE SKILLS

- IT & Telecom Category Management | Software/SaaS Licensing | Cloud Procurement (AWS/Azure/GCP) | Hardware & Devices | IT Managed Services & Outsourcing
- MSA / NDA / SOW Redline Negotiation | CLM Governance (GEP) | Supplier Risk | Contract Renewals Management
- Strategic Sourcing | RFx & e-Auctions | TCO Modelling | Spend Analytics | Supplier Consolidation | LCC Sourcing | Make-vs-Buy Analysis
- S2P / P2P Lifecycle (SAP MM, GEP Smart) | Demand Planning | Inventory Management | Supplier Performance KPIs | ESG / Ecovadis Compliance
- AI / NLP / Machine Learning | MS 365 Copilot (Early Adopter) | Python | RPA / Power Automate | SAP BW / Power BI / Advanced Excel | Digital Procurement Transformation

WORK EXPERIENCE

NV Bekaert SA | Global Steel Wire and Coating Technologies

Procurement Category Specialist — Global IT & Telecom Jan 2023 – Present

EUR 3.96B revenue | 27,000 employees | 62 manufacturing plants | 130+ countries | IT & Telecom Spend: EUR 62M | Global

Software, SaaS & Licensing

- Own enterprise software and SaaS procurement across 62 plants — ERP, productivity suites, cybersecurity, analytics, collaboration, and engineering tools. Negotiate multi-year enterprise agreements, true-ups, subscription renewals, and usage-based licensing structures independently.

- Drive SaaS license optimization — utilization analysis, shadow IT identification, and tool consolidation across business units. Source and evaluate emerging digital procurement platforms including GEP Smart, RPA tools, and AI automation software.

Hardware, Telecom & Network

- Manage global hardware procurement — end-user devices, servers, storage, and networking equipment. Global vendor panel management, volume consolidation, TCO-based lifecycle evaluation covering support SLAs and refresh cycles.
- Own Telecom & Network category across operations — mobile/fixed-line contracts, WAN/SD-WAN, internet connectivity. Carrier rationalization, competitive RFPs, invoice auditing, and tariff benchmarking to drive continuous cost reduction.

Cloud Services & IT Managed Services

- Govern Cloud Services spend (AWS, Azure, GCP) enterprise agreement negotiations, committed use discounts, reserved instance structuring, FinOps-aligned consumption governance, and GDPR/data residency compliance management.
- Lead IT Managed Services & Outsourcing procurement — SOW structuring, milestone-based payment terms, service desk and application management contracts, TPRM assessments for cybersecurity and data privacy compliance.

Contract Negotiations, CLM & Supplier Governance

- Independently review redlines and negotiate MSAs, NDAs, and SOWs — identify commercial and legal risks, propose solutions, and execute agreements with Legal across full IT/Telecom supplier base in SAP and CLM platform.
- Manage IT contract lifecycle — proactive renewal management 90–120 days in advance, SLA obligation monitoring, GDPR compliance tracking, and CLM metadata governance across EUR 62M supplier base.
- Govern supplier KPIs — uptime, fault resolution, OTD, and service quality scorecards with quarterly supplier performance reviews and structured corrective action processes.

Category Strategy, Spend Analytics & Stakeholder Management

- Develop and execute IT & Telecom category strategies — spend analysis, supply market intelligence, pricing benchmarking, and stakeholder alignment across CIO/CTO office, Finance, Legal, and business units in a matrix organization.
- Deliver IT spend analytics in Power BI and SAP BW — shadow IT, off-contract spend, supplier concentration, and consolidation opportunities surfaced continuously. Partner with Finance/FP&A on IT budget cycles, cost allocation, and savings validation.
- Operate across global matrix — collaborating daily with European HQ (Belgium), and global team.

AI, Copilot & Digital Procurement — Early Adopter

- Early adopter of MS 365 Copilot in procurement — uses Copilot daily for RFx drafting, contract redline summarization, spend report generation, CLM metadata enrichment, and supplier communication across the global team.
- Built NLP-based SAP Material Master De-Duplication Engine — fuzzy matching and linguistic pattern recognition detected thousands of duplicate IT supplier records globally, improving spend data quality and enabling reliable category consolidation.
- Deployed RPA + AI end-to-end PO Automation — bot executes sourcing workflows, parses IT supplier quotation responses via AI, auto-updates SAP and CLM records, and triggers approval and renewal reminders. 80–90% admin workload eliminated.
- Developed AI Supplier Finder Tool — NLP applied to SAP invoice and contract data surfaces pre-approved IT suppliers instantly, eliminating shadow procurement and reducing new vendor introduction.

Key Results

- Double-digit recurring savings on EUR 62M IT & Telecom portfolio — SaaS optimization, carrier rationalization, and cloud commercial governance.
- 60–70% procurement admin workload eliminated — live AI and RPA automation in daily global use by Bekaert procurement team.
- 400+ supplier contracts governed — MSA/NDAs/SOWs independently negotiated and CLM-tracked across global IT supplier base.
- MS 365 Copilot adopted as standard daily procurement tool — RFx, contracts, spend reporting, and CLM workflows accelerated.

JCB Industries Pvt. Ltd. | Pune & Vadodara, India

Purchase Engineer — IT & All India Category Procurement Jul 2020 – Dec 2022

GBP 100M Vadodara greenfield plant | All India Category Mandate | Plant inaugurated April 2022 | Exports to 110+ countries

- Owned all India procurement categories (Vadodara Plant)— IT infrastructure (servers, networking, ERP/SAP MM, production control systems, workstations), hardware, software, facilities, civil services, CAPEX equipment, MRO, and logistics fleet.
- Delivered EUR 21M (approx. INR 190 Cr) savings — 30% reduction on EUR 70M India procurement mandate through competitive RFQ/RFP tendering, TCO modelling, make-vs-buy analysis, and multi-round commercial negotiations across all categories.
- Negotiated IT services contracts, hardware supply agreements, and 10-year AMC contracts — SLA uptime guarantees, data security terms, fixed pricing, and favorable escalation clauses executed independently with Legal.
- Built complete SAP MM procurement infrastructure — vendor master, contract archive, purchasing parameters, P2P workflows, sourcing frameworks, supplier onboarding SOPs, and procurement governance policy.
- Managed cross-functional coordination across IT, Engineering, Finance, Legal, and Project teams — procurement timelines aligned with civil and commissioning milestones throughout the plant build.

Key Results

- EUR 21M (INR 190 Cr) savings — 30% below EUR 70M India procurement budget.
- All India categories managed independently — IT, hardware, software, CAPEX, MRO, facilities, civil, logistics.
- Full procurement infrastructure — SAP MM, vendor master, contracts, P2P governance, and SOPs.
- 10-year AMC contracts secured — fixed pricing, guaranteed SLAs, and long-term cost certainty locked in.

TOOLS & TECHNOLOGY

Procurement / ERP: SAP MM, SAP, SAP BW, SAP SRM, GEP Smart (S2P / P2P / Sourcing / Contracts / SRM)

CLM Platforms: GEP — contract creation, redline workflows, metadata governance, obligation tracking

Analytics: Power BI, SAP BW, Advanced Excel (Pivot Tables, Macros, VBA), Tableau (familiar), QlikView (familiar)

AI & Automation: MS 365 Copilot (daily user), Python (Pandas, NLP, Fuzzy Logic, Web Scraping), RPA, Power Automate, ChatGPT / LLMs

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud Platform — enterprise agreements, committed use, FinOps cost governance

Project Management: MS Project

EDUCATION

PGDM — Project Management & Supply Chain Analytics | MIT School of Distance Education, Pune | CGPA 9.5/10 | 2024 – 2026

B.Tech — Mechanical Engineering | MIT Academy of Engineering (MIT-AOE), Pune University | CGPA 8.85/10 | 2020

Diploma — Mechanical Engineering | Government Polytechnic, Khamgaon | 86.71% | 2017

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- Certified Supply Chain Professional (CSCMP) Supply Chain Foundations | Council of Supply Chain Management Professionals
- MS 365 Copilot — Early Adopter & Active Daily User | Microsoft
- Data Science Pro-Degree | Imarticus Learning
- AI by Dell | Dell Technologies
- Prompt Engineering with ChatGPT | LinkedIn Learning
- Project Management: Procurement | LinkedIn Learning

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- Languages: English, Hindi, Marathi
- Global procurement exposure across India, Belgium, Slovakia, China, North America, and EMEA — daily cross-cultural collaboration with European HQ and Asian manufacturing teams.
- Open to relocation: Europe (Belgium, Germany, Netherlands, UK), APAC, Middle East, or Americas.
- Passionate advocate for AI-driven digital transformation in IT procurement and supply chain operations.